

How to Manually Lock/Unlock Main Branch (Monolith & Automation Repos)



Purpose:

Temporarily block merge requests or direct pushes to the main branch to protect against regression breakage during triage and fix.

Locking Main Branch in GitLab

1. **Navigate to Project Settings**
Go to the **GitLab repo** (e.g., [monolith](#)) or [automation](#)).
2. **Access Branch Rules**
 - Go to Settings Repository Protected Branches.
3. **Protect main Branch**
 - In the "Protect a branch" section:
 - **Branch:** main
 - **Allowed to push:** *No one*
 - **Allowed to merge:** *No one*
 - Click **Protect**.

You've now locked the main branch — no MRs or direct commits can proceed.

Unlocking Main Branch in GitLab

1. Go to the same Protected Branches section.
2. Find the main branch in the list.
3. Click **Unprotect** or **Edit Permissions**.
4. Restore previous permissions (e.g., Maintainers can merge).

The branch is now open again for regular CI/CD operations.

Suggested Note

Include this at the end of your updated section:

"This is a temporary manual process until automation is in place for branch lock/unlock triggers based on nightly regression outcomes."